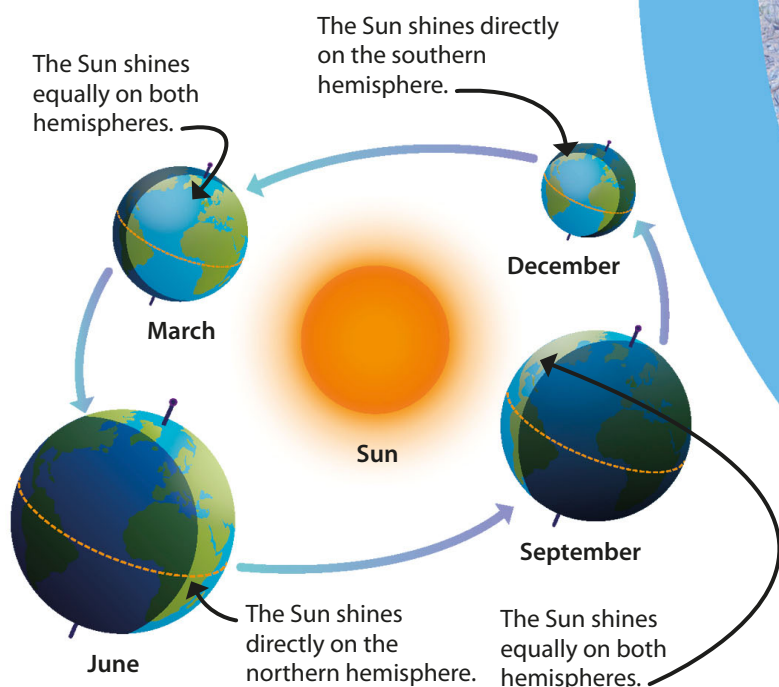


Seasons and climate

Earth takes a year to travel, or orbit, around the Sun. At the same time, it spins on its axis, an imaginary line between the Poles. This means the amount of sunlight falling on any area of Earth varies during the year, changing the weather and creating seasons – spring, summer, autumn, and winter.

How seasons change

Earth tilts on its axis as it spins and orbits around the Sun. This tilt causes one half, or hemisphere, of Earth to lean towards the Sun, while the other half leans away. In the half leaning towards the Sun, it is summer. In the other half, it will then be winter.



SPRING

Spring is a time of change between summer and winter. Days gradually get brighter, warmer, and wetter. Leaves start to grow on the trees and baby animals are born.

WINTER

Winter is the coldest season. Days get shorter and nights get longer. Some animals grow thick coats to keep them warm in winter. Others just fall asleep, or hibernate.